Topic 21 — International Relations

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

India's Foreign Policy | Panchsheel | Non-Alignment | NAM | UNSC | Global Security Organizations | Djibouti Code of Conduct (आचरण नियमावली) | USA Foreign Policy | UN | IMF | World Bank | WTO | WHO | UNESCO | ILO | ICJ | BRICS | G20 | SCO | BIMSTEC | ASEAN | SAARC | QUAD | IORA | Commonwealth | APEC | OECD

Sources baked in: UN Charter, Bretton Woods, WTO/Marrakesh, grouping charters, UPPCS PYQs 2018–2025 (BIMSTEC / IMF–WB / G20 / BRICS / SCO) **Weight:** ★★★ — BIMSTEC **not Indonesia** (2025); Bretton Woods twins, **both HQ Washington** not WB-New York (2025); G20 logo **lotus + 7 petals = 7 continents** (2023); G20 in UP **not Kanpur** (2023); 5th BIMSTEC chaired by **Sri Lanka not India** (2022); BRICS 10th summit **South Africa 2018 Last verified:** September 2026 · Ghatnachakra international organisations and foreign-policy drill added **Current Affairs:** G20 New Delhi **Sep 2023** + AU as member; BRICS expansion **2024**; SCO Iran **2023** / Belarus **2024**; India SCO chair **2022–23**; BIMSTEC 5th summit Colombo **2022**

Current Affairs (what the year actually tests)

Newest first. One event, one fact.

Year	What happened	What you mark
2024	BRICS adds **Egypt (मिस्र), Ethiopia, Iran, UAE** (Saudi invited)	Original 5 still in; this is **expansion**, not a UN organ
2024	**Belarus** joins SCO	After **Iran 2023**. RATS still **Tashkent**
2024	19th NAM Summit at **Kampala, Uganda**	NAM is **alive**; India attends; it is still **not** NATO
2024	**Sweden** joins NATO (Finland was **2023**)	NATO membership **32**. India still **out**
2023	G20 New Delhi Summit **9–10 Sep**; **AU** admitted as a member	India president **Dec 2022–Nov 2023**. Logo = lotus, **7 petals = 7 continents**
2023	G20 working meetings in UP: **Agra, Varanasi (वाराणसी), Greater Noida, Lucknow (लखनऊ)**	**Kanpur (कानपुर) was not** a venue (2023 paper)
2023	SCO Film Festival **Mumbai** during India's SCO chair	India chaired SCO **2022–23**; festival **does** show member films
2023	**Iran** becomes SCO member	India+Pak were **2017**; Iran is later
2022	WHO Global Centre for Traditional Medicine at **Jamnagar**	Not Haridwar (हरिद्वार), not Jaffna, not Johannesburg (2022 paper)
2022	5th BIMSTEC Summit, **Colombo, 30 Mar**	Chair = **Sri Lanka**, not India. Modi **did** address it

Year	What happened	What you mark
2022	India's elected UNSC term **2021–22** ends	8th elected term. India is **not** P5
2021	G7 Cornwall, **UK chair**; India invited as guest	India is **not** G7. Brazil was **not** the guest in that stem
2021	**AUKUS** announced; Quad Leaders' summit	AUKUS = AUS–UK–US. Quad **includes India**
2021	Vaccine Maitri	Outreach colour under "India FP", not a Charter article
2020	EAS 2020 host = **Vietnam**, not Singapore	India **is** in EAS. Match-the-summit papers lie on the city
2020	**BECA** signed with the US	Last of the four (चातुर्याम) foundational pacts. **Not** NATO membership
2019	India walks out of **RCEP**	Still Act East / ASEAN dialogue partner
2019	Jaishankar at **OIC** (Abu Dhabi) as guest	**Guest ≠ member**. India is **not** in the OIC
2018	10th BRICS Summit **Johannesburg**	Host = **South Africa** (2018 paper)
2018	**COMCASA**	Comms pact with US — not a base treaty
2017	India + Pakistan join **SCO**	SCO is **not** NATO and **not** SAARC
2017	**Jeddah Amendment** to the Djibouti Code	Piracy code **widened** to other maritime crime
2016	**LEMOA**	Logistics access, not a foreign military base
2015	**SAGAR** coined (Mauritius); **NDB** Shanghai	SAGAR = India's phrase. NDB = BRICS bank, **not** IMF
2014	Act East at ASEAN; last SAARC summit **Kathmandu**	Look East **upgraded**. SAARC leaders' track **stalls**
2011	Obama "pivot to Asia"	US FP turn the paper still uses
2008	**123 Agreement** + **NSG (एनएसजी) waiver**	Civil nuclear with US; India still **outside NPT**
1971	PRC takes UN China seat (Res. **2758**)	India voted **for** PRC. ROC/Taiwan out of the UN seat
1950	Uniting for Peace **377(V)**	GA can *recommend* (सिफारिश) if the veto kills the Council

Frame

How independent India chose not to join a Cold-War camp, what **Panchsheel / NAM** actually were, who can **veto** at the UN, and which **clubs** (UN family, Bretton Woods, SAARC/BIMSTEC/G20) India is in or out of. Art. 51 (promote international peace) is a DPSP (राज्य के नीति निदेशक तत्व) — Art. 51 is a DPSP: promote international peace.

India's Foreign Policy

Independent judgment + **UN-centred peace** + **neighbourhood** + (after 1991) **Look/Act East** + (after 2014) **SAGAR / Indo-Pacific**. "Non-alignment" is the Cold-War *name* of that judgment; "strategic autonomy" is the later *name*. Same instinct.

- **1947–64 Nehru:** Panchsheel · NAM seed · UN activism · Afro-Asian solidarity. **Not** "India had no friends"
- **1971:** Indo–Soviet Treaty of Peace, Friendship — a **tilt**, still not a NATO-style membership
- **1991:** Look East (Narasimha Rao) as LPG opens Asia
- **1998:** Pokhran-II — nuclear doctrine later (NFU is policy, not a treaty)
- **2014–:** Neighbourhood First · **Act East** · **SAGAR** · Indo-Pacific · Quad *as a dialogue*

Gujral Doctrine

Non-reciprocity toward smaller neighbours (1996–97, I.K. Gujral) — Nepal, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Maldives, Sri Lanka. **Not** a Pakistan-surrender doctrine; Pakistan was never in that five.

Look East / Act East / SAGAR

- **Look East (1991)** — economic + ASEAN door after 1991
- **Act East (2014**, Nay Pyi Taw ASEAN) — Look East **plus** security, connectivity, NE as a bridge. **RCEP walkout Nov 2019** is *not* a repeal of Act East
- **SAGAR (2015**, Mauritius) — **Security and Growth for All in the Region** — Indian Ocean, not a NATO
- **Neighbourhood First** (2014 framing) — immediate ring first. SAARC stalled (includes Pakistan); BIMSTEC is the Bay-of-Bengal workaround
- **Vaccine Maitri (2021)** — COVID vaccine outreach — CA colour, not a new "doctrine article"
- Art. **51** DPSP — foster international peace, respect international law, settle disputes peacefully

What Indian FP is *not*: Isolation (India joined the UN on day-one; NAM is *not* leaving the world) · Neutrality (Swiss *legal* stay-out; non-alignment still **votes**, **peacekeeps**, **tilts** 1971) · Camp-follower (not SEATO/CENTO/NATO; 1971 = **tilt**, still not Art. 5) · Pacifism (1962/65/71/99/Kargil (कारगिल) — FP is not "no army (सेना)").

Nuclear + US pacts (security-diplomacy, asked as FP) - **NPT 1968** / **CTBT 1996** — India is **not** a signatory - Pokhran-II **1998** — tests. Doctrine later: **credible minimum + NFU** (policy, not a treaty) - **123 Agreement** with US **2008** — civil nuclear; enabled NSG. **NSG waiver 2008** — India trades nuclear *without* being an NPT member - **GSOMIA 2002** · **LEMOA 2016** (logistics access, **not** a base treaty, **not** NATO) · **COMCASA 2018** (was CISMOA) · **BECA 2020** (geo-spatial / maps)

2+2 (defence + foreign ministers): **USA, Japan, Australia, Russia**. Not a UN organ. **I2U2 (2022):** India–Israel–UAE–USA. Minilateral, not NATO.

Other phrases: **Connect Central Asia (2012)** · Think/Link West · **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam** (G20 2023 colour) · diaspora / Pravasi as a tool, not a doctrine.

India is **not** a member of NATO, AUKUS, Five Eyes, CSTO, **OIC**, or the EU. Commonwealth republic-membership (London Declaration **1949**) = organisations card.

Machinery: **MEA** (EAM) · Foreign Secretary · **NSA** · **CCS** (सुरक्षा कैबिनेट समिति) (PM + HM + RM + FM) — PMO/NSA often run the hard files.

> **Logic:** Look East = **1991**. Act East = **2014**. LEMOA = logistics **access**, not NATO. NFU is a **national doctrine**, not a UN treaty.

Panchsheel

Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence — 29 April 1954 Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between the Tibet Region of China and India. Nehru and Zhou Enlai (the five are in the agreement's preamble (प्रस्तावना)). Hindi: **पंचशील**.

The five — write all five

1. Mutual respect for each other's **territorial integrity and sovereignty**
2. Mutual **non-aggression**
3. Mutual **non-interference** in each other's internal affairs
4. **Equality** and mutual benefit
5. **Peaceful co-existence**

- Bandung **18–24 Apr 1955**, Indonesia — Afro-Asian; the five are restated. Precursor mood for NAM, **not** NAM itself (NAM = 1961)
- Bandung listed **ten** principles (incl. human rights, UN Charter, peaceful dispute-settlement). **Do not** write "Bandung = exactly the five". The five are *inside* the ten
- Same 1954 agreement: India treats the **Tibet Region as part of China**
- The five have been cited in later UN language — still **not** a UN Charter article
- Panchsheel is **not** in the Indian Constitution as a schedule. Art. **51** is the DPSP cousin
- 1962 war did **not** "repeal" Panchsheel as a *text*. The paper still asks the **five** and the **1954** year

> **Logic:** Panchsheel **1954**. NAM **1961 Belgrade**. Bandung 1955 is the **mood**, not the first NAM summit.

Non-Alignment and NAM

Non-alignment is a policy (issue-by-issue judgment, no Cold-War camp). **NAM is a movement of States** (first summit **1961 Belgrade**). Not an alliance.

	Non-alignment	NAM
What	A **policy**: no military camp in the Cold War; issue-by-issue judgment	A **movement of States**, first summit **1961 Belgrade**

	Non-alignment	NAM
Founders (five names)	—	**Nehru** (नेहरू) (India) · **Nasser** (Egypt) · **Tito** (Yugoslavia) · **Sukarno** (Indonesia) · **Nkrumah** (Ghana (घन))
Military?	Explicitly **not** an alliance	**No** Art. 5, **no** standing army, **no** Brussels HQ

- First summit **1961, Belgrade**. India hosted **7th Summit, New Delhi, 1983** (Indira Gandhi (गांधी))
- Latest for CA: **19th Summit, Kampala (Uganda), 2024**
- Size ~**120** members (don't freeze a one-off extra)
- Coordinating Bureau at the **UN in New York** — not a NATO-style HQ
- What NAM is **not**: isolation · "third military bloc" · SEATO · a replacement for the UN
- Summit raata (only the ones that print): **1st Belgrade 1961** · 2nd **Cairo 1964** · 5th **Colombo 1976** (neighbour) · **7th New Delhi 1983** · 8th Harare 1986 · 17th Venezuela 2016 · 18th **Baku 2019** · **19th Kampala 2024**
- **NIEO** — 1970s NAM/G77 push for a **New International Economic Order** — economics, not Art. 5
- Observers (China has been one). Observer ≠ founder ≠ P5
- Chair rotates with the summit host — **not** a Secretary-General like the UN

Cold-War line: NATO vs Warsaw Pact were the two *alliances*; NAM refused to be a third *alliance* and claimed a third *path*.

Neutrality ≠ non-alignment: a neutral (Swiss model) *stays out of wars by law*. A non-aligned State **chooses** each file — including a 1971 tilt.

> **Logic:** Bandung 1955 is the **mood**. First NAM summit = **Belgrade 1961**. NAM has **no** Art. 5.

UNSC (United Nations Security Council)

UN principal organ with primary responsibility for international peace and security (Charter Chapter **V**). **15** members: **5 permanent + 10 non-permanent**.

- **P5:China · France · Russia · UK · USA**. Each has a **veto** on *substantive* (not merely procedural) decisions
- Elected 10: **two-year** terms; not eligible immediately for re-election. Regional math: Africa **3** · Asia-Pacific **2** · GRULAC **2** · WEOG **2** · Eastern Europe **1**
- Presidency: **monthly**, alphabetical rotation of members
- Chapter **VII** — binding measures, up to force — the "teeth" chapter
- Peacekeeping: Council mandates; India has been among the largest troop contributors historically
- India elected **eight** times. Last: **2021–22**. India is **not** a P5 member. "Veto power of India" is false
- Permanent seat? India **wants** one. Vehicle = **G4** (India, Japan, Germany, Brazil) + African claim
- Opposition brand: **Uniting for Consensus / Coffee Club** (Italy, Pakistan, etc.) — expand *elected* seats, **not** new permanents

- A P5 **abstention** is **not** a veto. The draft can still pass
- **Uniting for Peace** — GA Res **377(V), 3 Nov 1950** — if the Council is **veto-paralysed**, the **General Assembly** can meet in emergency special session (पंगु सत्र) and *recommend* measures (Korea / Suez). **Does not** give India a veto
- China seat: **Res. 2758 (1971)** — **PRC** takes the China seat; ROC/Taiwan out. India voted **for** seating PRC
- Art. **108**: Charter change needs all **P5 ratifications**. Adding a sixth permanent member is not a GA majority trick
- Ezulwini — African Union position: **two** permanent African seats (with veto, in the AU ask) — neighbour of G4, not G4 itself
- Art. **27** — voting (गणपूर्ति) rule in the Charter — veto sits here as "concurring votes of the permanent members" on non-procedural matters. TCC ≠ P5

> **Logic:** India = elected member, 8 terms, last **2021–22**. Abstention ≠ veto. Uniting for Peace ≠ Indian veto.

Global Security Organizations

Cold-War alliances + 21st-century minilaterals. **SCO / QUAD** as clubs have their own cards below.

NATO

Collective-defence alliance — Washington Treaty **4 Apr 1949**. **Art. 5** — attack on one = attack on all. HQ **Brussels**. **32** members after **Finland 2023** and **Sweden Mar 2024**. **India is not a member**. - **Art. 4** = consultation (used more often than 5). **Art. 5** invoked once — after **9/11** - Founding members **12** (1949). Secretary-General ≠ US President

AUKUS

Australia–UK–US minilateral (**Sep 2021**) — nuclear-powered **submarines** for Australia + extra tech. **Not** Quad; **India is not in AUKUS**.

QUAD (security fact)

India–Japan–US–Australia dialogue — revived 2017–. **Not NATO Art. 5**, **not AUKUS**. Full card with groupings.

Dead / India-out clubs

- **Warsaw Pact1955** → **dissolved 1991** — USSR's answer to NATO. Dead
- **SEATO** 1954–1977 — US Asian pact. **India never joined** (Pakistan did)
- **CENTO / Baghdad Pact** 1955–1979 — West Asia. **India never joined**
- **ANZUS** 1951 — Australia–NZ–US. India out
- **CSTO** 1992/2002 — Russia-led, post-Soviet. India out
- **Five Eyes** — WWII-origin intel: US, UK, Canada, Australia, NZ. **Not** a UN organ. India out

- **OSCE** — 1975 Helsinki → today's OSCE. Europe's security *talk-shop* + election watch. Not NATO. India out
- **OAS** 1948 — Americas. India out
- **Arab League** 1945 — Arab States. India out
- **OIC** 1969 — Organisation of Islamic Cooperation. **India is not a member** (Guest at 2019 Abu Dhabi is CA colour, not membership)
- **AU** 2002 (OAU 1963) — African Union; **APSA** = African Peace and Security Architecture. India out
- **GCC** 1981 — Gulf six. India out; close energy partner
- **IONS 2008** — Indian Ocean Naval Symposium — navies of the IOR, India a founder-type host. **Not** NATO
- **Shangri-La Dialogue** — annual, Singapore, IISS. Track-1.5 defence talk. Not a treaty

Collective security vs collective defence (write this once)

	Collective security	Collective defence
Idea	The *system* punishes a breaker of peace	*Allies* fight if one of them is attacked
Exhibit	UN Charter Chapter **VII**	NATO **Art. 5** (also CSTO, ANZUS)
India	UN peacekeeping / Chapter VII mandates	**Not** in Art. 5 clubs

- UN peacekeeping is mandated by the **Security Council** (not the General Assembly alone).
- India deployed the **first all-women Formed Police Unit** to **Liberia (UNMIL, January 2007)**.

> **Logic:** AUKUS = **AUS–UK–US**. Quad **includes India**. NATO Art. 5 does **not** bind India.

Djibouti Code of Conduct

IMO piracy instrument for the Western Indian Ocean / Gulf of Aden — signed **2009** at Djibouti. Not a military alliance.

- Original job: **piracy and armed robbery** against ships (नावाध्यक्ष)
- **Jeddah Amendment, January 2017** — widens to trafficking, illegal fishing, maritime terrorism / wider maritime crime
- Who signs: **regional coastal States** of that water (Djibouti, Somalia, Yemen, Kenya, Maldives, Seychelles…)
- India: major IOR navy; **partner / capacity-builder / observer-type** association. Do **not** mark "India is a 2009 coastal signatory in the same breath as Yemen" unless a paper prints a fresh accession note
- Info-sharing: regional centres (classically **Sana'a, Mombasa, Dar es Salaam**)
- Neighbour **ReCAAP 2006** — Asia piracy, Information Sharing Centre **Singapore**. India is a **ReCAAP** contracting party — that does **not** make ReCAAP the Djibouti Code

- Neighbour ops: EU NAVFOR **Atalanta** · NATO Ocean Shield (wound down) · Combined Maritime Forces. India's **Operation Sankalp (2019–)** = Gulf/Red Sea shipping escort — national, not the Code itself
- ≠ NATO · **SAGAR** (India's *own* 2015 phrase) · **UNCLOS** (constitution of the sea) · IORA (groupings card)

> **Logic:** ReCAAP **2006 Asia** ≠ Djibouti Code **2009 WIO**. SAGAR ≠ the Code. India is a **partner**, not Yemen-class coastal signatory.

USA Foreign Policy (basic)

UPPCS wants **doctrine names and centuries**, not a White House diary.

- **Monroe Doctrine (1823)** — Western Hemisphere — extra-European powers stay out
- Isolationist habit (19th–1930s) — US late to both World Wars as a *European* fighter
- **Wilson / 14 Points (1918)** — League of Nations idea. **US Senate refused** the League — US was **not** a League member
- Atlantic Charter **1941** — FDR–Churchill; seed of the UN. San Francisco Conference **1945** — UN born; US is a **P5** and hosts HQ (New York)
- **Kennan / containment** 1946–47 — intellectual parent of Truman
- **Truman Doctrine (1947)** — **containment** of the USSR — aid to Greece/Turkey
- Marshall (मार्शल) Plan **1948** — reconstruct Western Europe. **NATO 1949** — military arm of containment (Art. 5)
- **Eisenhower Doctrine (1957)** — Middle East — US aid against international communism
- **Nixon Doctrine** 1969 — allies do more of their own fighting. Nixon / China **1972** — opening to PRC; detente with Moscow
- **Carter Doctrine (1980)** — Persian (फ़ारसी) Gulf = US vital interest
- Unipolar moment **1991** — USSR gone. War on Terror **2001** after 9/11
- **Bush (Jr) pre-emption (2002 NSS)** — strike before being struck — Iraq debate
- **Pivot / Rebalance to Asia (2011**, Obama) — weight shifts to Indo-Pacific
- America First (Trump) — unilateral; sceptical of NATO-as-charity
- Indo-Pacific minilaterals 2017– — **Quad** (with India) · **AUKUS** (without India)
- Isolationism vs internationalism — two *habits*: Monroe in the first; Truman/NATO in the second

> **Logic:** AUKUS ≠ Quad**. Truman ≠ Monroe. NATO Art. 5 is** not **an Indian obligation.** US founded the UN but refused the League**.

International Organisations

UNSC **veto / P5 / India's 8 elected terms** = already above. Here = the **UN family**, money bodies, and **membership tables** the paper actually prints.

United Nations

Intergovernmental organisation — Charter signed **26 June 1945** (San Francisco); in force **24 Oct 1945** = **UN Day**. India is a **founding** member.

- Members **193**. Original **51**. Observer: Holy See, Palestine (not "194th member")
- HQ **New York**. ICJ sits at **The Hague**. Offices also Geneva / Vienna / Nairobi
- Official languages **six**: English, French, Spanish, Russian, Chinese, **Arabic**
- Charter: preamble + 19 chapters. Purposes: peace, rights, international law, social progress
- SG appointed by GA on **SC recommendation**. **Five-year** term, renewable. Not a head of state. Don't freeze the sitting (बैठक) name
- India colour: **Vijaya Lakshmi Pandit** — first woman President of the **UNGA (1953)**. Peacekeeping TCC. **Not** P5

Six principal organs (write all six)

General Assembly

193 members, one-state-one-vote — New York. **Recommendations** (except budget/elections).

Security Council

15 members; P5 veto — New York. Card above.

ECOSOC

54 members, 3-year terms — New York. Coordinates specialised agencies. - Members are elected by the **UN General Assembly** on the basis of **regional representation** (Africa, Asia-Pacific, Eastern Europe, Latin America & Caribbean, Western Europe and others). - ECOSOC is a **principal organ** of the UN. It is **not** a subsidiary organ of the Security Council. - **India** was elected under the **Asia-Pacific** group for the term **2026–28** (term begins **1 January 2026**; India secured **181** of **187** valid votes in the June 2025 GA election). - Former diplomat **Preeti Saran** was **re-elected** to the UN **Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (CESCR)** (fresh term commonly cited as **2027–2030**; she has also chaired CESCR). Do not swap her with Ruchira Kamboj / Eenam Gambhir / Sneha Dubey in CESCR stems.

ICJ

UN principal judicial organ — **The Hague**. Own card below.

Secretariat

SG + staff — New York.

Trusteeship Council

Inactive since 1994 (Palau). Still a principal organ on paper. New York.

Specialised agencies are **not** principal organs: WHO, UNESCO, ILO, IMF, World Bank, FAO (Rome), ICAO… sit next to the UN, linked via ECOSOC.

Agency ≠ programme: UNDP, UNICEF, UNHCR, UNCTAD are **programmes/offices**, not specialised agencies. HDI / HDR = **UNDP** (1990) — not IMF, not World Bank. UNFCCC (यूएनएफसीसीसी) / climate COP = ecology (पारिस्थितिकी) sheet, not this card.

> **Logic:** UN Day = **24 Oct** (in force), not 26 June (signed). Trusteeship is **inactive**, not abolished. WHO is **not** a principal organ.

IMF & World Bank (Bretton Woods twins)

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q140

World Bank and IMF: (1) set up together, called Bretton Woods Twins (2) HQ of IMF and World Bank are Washington D.C. and New York respectively A. Only 2 B. Neither C. Both D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: D — Only 1. Both were born at **Bretton Woods 1944** (opened 1945). **Both headquarters = Washington D.C.** World Bank is **not** in New York (that's the UN).

	IMF	World Bank Group
Job	Macro / **BOP** / exchange rates / crisis lending	**Development / reconstruction** project loans
Born	**July 1944** conference at **Bretton Woods, New Hampshire**. Articles **27 Dec 1945**	**IBRD** same conference
HQ	**Washington D.C.**	**Washington D.C.**
Trap	Bretton Woods is the *place of the 1944 meeting*, **not** the HQ city	HQ is **not** New York (UN) and **not** Bretton Woods village
Vote	**Quota** (roughly GDP). US largest	IBRD similar weighted vote; President **conventionally US**
Head	Managing Director — conventionally **European**	President — conventionally **US**
Money	**SDR** (1969) = unit of account. Basket classically **USD, EUR, CNY, JPY, GBP**. Not cash in your wallet	IBRD bonds + IDA donor replenishments

World Bank Group — five (don't write "the Bank = only IBRD") - **IBRD** — middle-income / creditworthy poor; original 1944 Bank - **IDA (1960)** — cheapest money for the poorest - **IFC** — private sector - **MIGA** — political-risk insurance - **ICSID** — investment-dispute centre

India is a **founding** member of IMF and IBRD. Constituency / Executive Director — don't freeze a name.

Neighbour **AIIB** (Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, **Beijing**, 2015/16): India is a **member** (large shareholder). **AIIB ≠ NDB ≠ IMF**. World Bank *Ease of Doing Business* ranking = economy file (report killed **2021**).

> **Logic:** Both twins HQ = **Washington D.C.** World Bank is **not** New York (that's the UN). Bretton Woods is the *1944 meeting place*, not the HQ city.

WTO

World Trade Organization — born **1 Jan 1995** (Marrakesh 1994). Successor to **GATT 1947**. GATT was a *treaty*; WTO is an *organisation*. HQ **Geneva**.

- Highest body: **Ministerial Conference** (every ~2 years). General Council in between
- Two trade laws: **MFN** (don't discriminate among members) · **National Treatment** (imports once in, treat like domestic)
- Pillars: **GATT** (goods) · **GATS** (services) · **TRIPS** (IP). Agriculture = **AoA**
- AoA boxes: Amber / Blue / Green — *classification of farm support*. Trap (2022): WTO does **not** simply "allow direct / ban indirect"
- Teeth: **Dispute Settlement** (Appellate Body has been blocked — CA, not "WTO is dead")
- India is a founding member. Public stockholding / food security is the usual Indian file
- ≠ IMF (BOP) · World Bank (projects) · UNCTAD (UN conference, Geneva, not the WTO)

> **Logic:** WTO HQ = **Geneva**, not Washington. GATT **1947**; WTO **1995**.

WHO

UN specialised health agency — founded **1948** | HQ **Geneva** | World Health Day **7 April**.

- The World Health Assembly is the decision body; the Director-General is elected.
- India sits in **SEARO** (South-East Asia Regional Office, **New Delhi**).
- The **Global Centre for Traditional Medicine** is at **Jamnagar (Gujarat)** — a UPPCS-tested India colour.
- Do not park WHO HQ in Paris (that is UNESCO) or New York (that is UNHQ).

> **Logic:** WHO Traditional Medicine Centre = **Jamnagar**, not Haridwar / Jaffna / Johannesburg.

UNESCO

UN specialised agency for education, science, culture — founded **1945** | HQ **Paris**.

- UNESCO runs the **World Heritage** (विश्व धरोहर) and **Intangible Cultural Heritage** lists.
- Which Indian site sits on which list belongs with Art & Culture / Ecology sheets — keep HQ and mandate here.
- Do not swap UNESCO (**Paris**) with WHO / ILO (**Geneva**).

> **Logic:** UNESCO HQ = **Paris**. WHO/ILO = **Geneva**.

ILO

Tripartite labour agency — founded **1919** (Versailles) | HQ **Geneva** | UN specialised agency from **1946**.

- Seats represent governments, employers, and workers together — that tripartite structure is the identity.
- India is a **founding** member.
- The Decent Work agenda and core conventions are the teaching colour — do not invent "India ratified all eight core conventions" unless a stem cites (साइट्स) a verified list.

ICJ

UN principal judicial organ (Charter Ch. **XIV**) — **The Hague**. *State vs State* + advisory opinions.

- **15 judges**, **9-year** terms, elected by **GA + SC**, no two from the same State
- **≠ ICC** (Rome **1998**, criminal, India **not** a party) · **≠ PCA** (also Hague, older) · **≠ ITLOS** (Hamburg, law of the sea)
- India colour: **Kulbhushan Jadhav** (India v. Pakistan) — ICJ 2017 provisional measures / **2019** judgment on consular access (Vienna Convention). That is *this* court, not the ICC

> **Logic:** ICJ = UN organ, States, Hague. ICC = Rome **1998**; India **not** a party. Jadhav ≠ ICC.

SAARC · ASEAN · BIMSTEC

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q91

Which is/are **NOT** a BIMSTEC member? 1 Thailand 2 Nepal 3 Bhutan 4 Indonesia A. 2 and 3 B. Only 4 C. 1 and 4 D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: B — Only 4 (Indonesia). BIMSTEC = **7**: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, **Thailand**. Indonesia is **ASEAN**, not BIMSTEC.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q119

BIMSTEC: (1) PM Modi addressed the 5th Summit on 30 Mar 2022 (2) 5th Summit was chaired by India A. Neither B. Both C. Only 2 D. Only 1

Show answer

Ans: D — Only 1. 5th Summit = **Colombo, 30 Mar 2022**, chair = **Sri Lanka**, not India.

	SAARC	ASEAN	BIMSTEC
Born	**8 Dec 1985**, Dhaka	**8 Aug 1967**, Bangkok Declaration	**6 June 1997** Bangkok as **BIST-EC** → Myanmar **Dec 1997** → Nepal+Bhutan **2004** = BIMSTEC
HQ	**Kathmandu**	**Jakarta**	Dhaka (secretariat **2014**)
Count	**8**	**10**	**7**
India	**Member**	**Not a member** (Dialogue Partner / EAS)	**Member**
Includes Pakistan?	**Yes**	No	**No**
Includes Maldives?	**Yes**	No	**No**
Includes Indonesia?	No	**Yes**	**No**
Includes Thailand / Myanmar?	No	**Yes**	**Yes**

SAARC

South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation — 8 Dec 1985, Dhaka. Secretariat **Kathmandu**. **8** members.

- **SAARC 8:** Afghanistan (joined **2007**), Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, Sri Lanka
- Observer list exists (China, US, EU…) — observer ≠ member. Charter needs **all** for some decisions — that's why the club **stalls**
- Last leaders' summit = **18th, Kathmandu, 2014**; Pakistan's turn for the 19th never landed
- Preferential trade: **SAPTA 1993** → **SAFTA 2006**. **South Asian University** sits in **New Delhi** — a SAARC project, not an ASEAN one

ASEAN

Association of Southeast Asian Nations — 8 Aug 1967, Bangkok Declaration. HQ **Jakarta**. **10** members. India is **not** a member.

- **ASEAN 10:** Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Vietnam. **Timor-Leste** is in line, not a freeze
- ASEAN Way = consensus, non-interference. India = **Dialogue Partner**, **EAS** member, **ARF** member — still **not** ASEAN-10
- **East Asia Summit (EAS):** ASEAN + India, China, Japan, Korea, Australia, NZ, USA, Russia. India **is in**. Host is the ASEAN chair. Trap (2020 paper): EAS **2020** was **Vietnam**, not Singapore

- **RCEP:** ASEAN-centred mega FTA. **India walked out November 2019**. Walking out of RCEP ≠ leaving Act East

BIMSTEC

Bay of Bengal Initiative — 7 members. India **is** a member. **No Pakistan, no Maldives, no Indonesia, no China.**

- **BIMSTEC 7 raata:** BBIN (Bangladesh Bhutan India Nepal) + Myanmar + Sri Lanka + Thailand. "SAARC minus Pakistan plus Thailand/Myanmar"
- Secretariat **Dhaka** (2014). **4th summit Kathmandu 2018**. **5th Colombo 2022** (SL chair) adopted (अंगीकृत) the **BIMSTEC Charter**

> **Logic:** Indonesia is **ASEAN**, not BIMSTEC. Maldives / Pakistan are **SAARC**, not BIMSTEC. 5th BIMSTEC Summit chaired by **Sri Lanka**, not India.

BRICS · G20 · SCO

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q12

10th BRICS Summit 2018 was held in— A. Brazil B. South Africa C. Russia D. China

Show answer

Ans: B — South Africa (Johannesburg).

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q81

India's G20 logo: (1) lotus with seven petals (2) seven petals = seven continents A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both D. Neither

Show answer

Ans: C — both. Earth + lotus; petals = **seven continents**. Theme **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q89

Which UP city was **not** a venue for G20 meetings during India's Presidency? A. Agra B. Varanasi C. Kanpur D. Greater Noida

Show answer

Ans: C — Kanpur. UP hosted in **Agra, Varanasi, Greater Noida, Lucknow**. Kanpur did not.

PYQ — UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q87

SCO Film Festival 2023: (1) during India's SCO Presidency (2) showcases films from SCO members A. Only 1 B. Only 2 C. Both D. Neither

Show answer

Ans: C — both. India chaired SCO **2022–23**; festival at **Mumbai**.

BRICS

Leaders' grouping from **2009** Yekaterinburg (acronym 2001 O'Neill). **Not** a UN organ.

- Original 5: Brazil, Russia, India, China, **South Africa (2010/11)**
- **NDB** Fortaleza **2014**, HQ **Shanghai**, first president **K.V. Kamath**. **CRA** (Contingent Reserve) sits beside NDB
- **2024** wave: **Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, UAE** (Saudi invited). Indonesia later CA
- **IBSA (2003)** = India–Brazil–South Africa. Older than BRICS-with-China; **≠ BRICS**

> **Logic:** 10th BRICS Summit **2018** = **South Africa** (Johannesburg). NDB = **Shanghai**, not IMF. NDB ≠ AIIB (Beijing).

G20

Finance 1999; leaders 2008. Forum, not a treaty. No UN-style HQ.

- **19 countries + EU + African Union (AU added 2023**, India presidency)
- India president **1 Dec 2022 – 30 Nov 2023**; New Delhi Leaders' Summit **9–10 Sep 2023**
- **Troika** = previous + current + next president. Logo 2023 = globe + lotus, **7 petals = 7 continents**, theme **Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam**
- UP venues = Agra, Varanasi, Greater Noida, **Lucknow** (लखनऊ) — **not Kanpur**
- **G7 neighbour:** Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, UK, USA (+ EU). **India is not a member** — guest only. 2021 summit: **UK chair** (Cornwall); guests were India/Australia/Korea/South Africa — **Brazil was not** the guest in that stem

> **Logic:** Lotus petals = **7 continents**, not 7 member-states. Kanpur was **not** a UP G20 venue.

SCO

Shanghai Cooperation Organisation — **2001** Shanghai, from **Shanghai Five (1996)**. Secretariat **Beijing**. **RATS** (anti-terror) **Tashkent**. Not NATO.

- Core: China, Russia, 4 Central Asian, **India + Pakistan 2017**, **Iran 2023**, **Belarus 2024**
- **Shanghai Five (1996) — write the five:** China, Russia, **Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan**. **Uzbekistan was not in the Five**; it joined when SCO was formed **2001**

> **Logic:** RATS = **Tashkent**; secretariat = **Beijing**. Uzbekistan not in Shanghai Five.

QUAD

India, Japan, USA, Australia — first try **2007** (Abe), faded; revived **2017**; Leaders' level **2021**.

- Quad is a **strategic dialogue**, not a NATO Article 5 mutual-defence treaty, and **not AUKUS**.
- Naval colour is the **Malabar** exercise (India–US from **1992**; Quad navies join later) — still an exercise, not a treaty.
- **India is inside Quad**. **India is outside AUKUS** (AUKUS = Australia, UK, USA).

> **Logic:** Quad **includes India**. AUKUS does **not**.

IORA

Indian Ocean Rim Association — founded **1997** in Mauritius (then IOR-ARC) | Secretariat **Ebene, Mauritius** | about **23** members plus dialogue partners.

- India is a founding-type member focused on blue economy (नीली अर्थव्यवस्था) and maritime safety.
- IORA is **not** the Djibouti Code of Conduct and **not** IONS.

> **Logic:** IORA secretariat = **Mauritius**, not Djibouti.

Commonwealth

About 56 members (number wiggles) | HQ **London** (Marlborough House).

- The **London Declaration 1949** let a **republic** stay — that is how India remained.
- Head of the Commonwealth is the British monarch as a **symbol**, not a viceroy (वायसराय). The Secretary-General runs the Secretariat.
- **Commonwealth Games** are not the Secretariat itself.

> **Logic:** Commonwealth is **not** only monarchies. 1949 let republics stay.

APEC · OECD

- **APEC (1989)** has **21** economies and a secretariat in **Singapore**. **India is not a member**.
- **OECD (1961)** has HQ in **Paris** as a rich-country policy club (~38). **India is not a member** (Key Partner).
- "Great Reset" 2021 paper colour belongs to **WEF**, not OECD.

> **Logic:** India is **out** of APEC and OECD; **in** G20.

Mains link (one frame)

Independent India refused a **camp** (NAM) but not the **UN** (founding member; elected UNSC, never P5). Money clubs: **Bretton Woods twins both Washington**, WTO **Geneva 1995** (MFN + National Treatment). Neighbourhood clubs: **SAARC stalled 2014** vs **BIMSTEC 7** (no Pakistan, no Indonesia). 2023 colour: **G20 presidency + AU + lotus/7 continents**; **Kanpur was not a UP venue**. Close with: **ASEAN member ≠ India**; **RCEP walkout ≠ Act East repeal**; **AUKUS ≠ Quad**; **ICJ ≠ ICC**; **G7 guest ≠ G7 member**; **APEC/OECD = India out**.